Legends and Stories about Animals

H 1720

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A. Background

Use of the subdivision ***--Legends and stories*** under types of animals was discontinued in 1981. Several subdivisions are now used in place of the discontinued subdivision.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from the Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Fiction***, ***Folk literature***, ***Legends***, etc.

B. Recent revisions

2026-02: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Fiction

To one or more fictitious stories about an animal or a group of animals, assign the subdivision ***--Fiction*** under the type of animal (cf. H 1790)

To collections of stories involving various types of animals, assign ***Animals--Fiction***.

LC practice: Do not use a form subdivision of the type ***--Fiction*.** Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from LCGFT, e.g. ***Fiction***, ***Animal fiction***, etc.

Example:

```
650 #0 $a Dogs $v Fiction.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Dogs.
655 #7 $a Animal fiction. $2 lcgft
```

D. Folklore

To one or more legends about an animal or group of animals, assign the subdivision ***--Folklore*** under the type of animal (cf. H 1627).

To collections of legends involving various types of animals, assign ***Animals--Folklore***.

LC practice: Do not use a form subdivision of the type ***--Folklore*.** Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from LCGFT, e.g. ***Folk literature***, ***Folk literature***, etc.

Example:

```
650 #0 $a Dogs $v Folklore.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Dogs.
655 #7 $a Folk tales. $2 lcgft
```

E. True stories about individual animals and pets

E.1. Collections

To collections of true-life stories about animals, assign the subdivision ***--Biography*** under the type of animal. Interpose geographic subdivision if appropriate and assign additional headings as needed.

LC practice: Do not use a form subdivision of the type ***--Biography*.** Instead, assign an appropriate term or terms from LCGFT, e.g. ***Biographies***, etc. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign LCDGT to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***Children***, ***Teenagers***, etc.

Examples:

```
Title: Great canine heroes of all time.
650 #0 $a Dogs $v Biography.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Dogs.
655 #7 $a Biographies. $2 lcgft
```

Title: James Herriot's treasury for children.

650 #0 $a Pets $z England $z Yorkshire $v Biography $v Juvenile literature.

650 #0 $a Domestic animals $z England $z Yorkshire $v Biography $v Juvenile literature.

650 #0 $a Farm life $z England $z Yorkshire $v Biography $v Juvenile literature.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Pets $z England $z Yorkshire.

650 #0 $a Domestic animals $z England $z Yorkshire.

650 #0 $a Farm life $z England $z Yorkshire.

655 #7 $a Biographies. $2 lcgft

385 ## $a Children $2 lcdgt

E.2. Individual biographies

For individual biographies, use the subdivision ***--Biography*** under types of animals, with geographic subdivision if appropriate. If the animal has a name that is established as a heading, or if the animal is well known enough for its name to be established, assign it as an additional heading. See H 1332, section 9, for guidelines on establishing headings for names of individual animals. Assign the owner's name(s) if appropriate.

LC practice: Do not use a form subdivision of the type ***--Biography*.** Instead, assign an appropriate term or terms from LCGFT, e.g. ***Biographies***, etc. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign LCDGT to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***Children***, ***Teenagers***, etc.

Example:

Title: Barry, the bravest Saint Bernard.

600 00 $a Barry $c (Dog), $d 1800-1814 $v Juvenile literature.

650 #0 $a Saint Bernard dog $z Switzerland $v Biography $v Juvenile literature.

650 #0 $a Rescue dogs $z Switzerland $v Biography $v Juvenile literature.

LC practice:

600 00 $a Barry $c (Dog), $d 1800-1814.

650 #0 $a Saint Bernard dog $z Switzerland.

650 #0 $a Rescue dogs $z Switzerland.

655 #7 $a Biographies. $2 lcgft

385 ## $a Children $2 lcdgt

E.3. Anecdotes about pets

To anecdotal accounts of pets, assign the subdivision ***--Anecdotes*** under the type of animal, with local subdivision if appropriate. Assign the owner's name(s) if appropriate.

LC practice: Do not use a form subdivision of the type ***--Anecdotes*.** Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from LCGFT, e.g. ***Anecdotes***, etc.

Example:

600 10 $a [*name of owner*]
650 #0 $a Dogs $z California $v Anecdotes.

LC practice:

600 10 $a [*name of owner*]
650 #0 $a Dogs $z California.
655 #7 $a Anecdotes. $2 lcgft

If the pet has a name that is established as a heading, or if the animal is well known enough for its name to be established, assign the name as an additional heading.

LC practice: Do not use a form subdivision of the type ***--Anecdotes*.** Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from LCGFT, e.g. ***Anecdotes***, etc.

Example:

600 10 $a Obama, Bo.
650 #0 $a Dogs $z Washington (D.C.) $v Anecdotes.

LC practice:

600 10 $a Obama, Bo.
650 #0 $a Dogs $z Washington (D.C.)
655 #7 $a Anecdotes. $2 lcgft

Revision history

2026-02: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.